

Question ID: f2208f98

Question

When Kenyan writer Ngũgĩ wa Thiong’o, who had previously published four novels in English, began writing in his native language, Gĩkũyũ, in the 1970s, several fellow writers and critics cautioned that doing so might make his works inaccessible outside his own community. Some noted that Kiswahili—widely spoken in Kenya and elsewhere in Africa—would be a more practical choice. Rejecting their arguments, Ngũgĩ went on to author dozens of acclaimed works in Gĩkũyũ that have been translated into a total of more than thirty languages.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

Answer

- A. The reaction to Ngũgĩ’s rejection of English illustrates that some literary experts believe that fame is most easily gained by writing in a widely understood language, such as Gĩkũyũ.
- B. Although Ngũgĩ insisted on publishing his first works in Gĩkũyũ, they have since been translated into many other languages.
- C. Although Ngũgĩ’s decision to write in Gĩkũyũ was met with some skepticism, it didn’t prevent him from achieving literary success.
- D. In the 1970s, Ngũgĩ became convinced that literature ought to be written in authors’ native languages, and he proceeded to publish many works in Gĩkũyũ.